[Open Call] The Mythos Chronicles



Second Chances
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Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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[Open Call] The Mythos Chronicles

#1
08-23-2016, 04:22 PM



Having just picked up the 7th Edition of Call of Cthulhu and being inundated with a Mythos Adventure Path in Pathfinder, I got myself thinking, where do the Mythos fit in Chronicles of Darkness?

This thread has two goals.

1. Brainstorm plots, ideas, hooks, monsters and NPCs for a Mythos-themed CofD game.
2. Develop a Dark Era based off of the 1920s that incorporate said themes. I would say that the primary regional focus of such an era would be the Northwest Atlantic (aka Lovecraft Country) but that it would also include events worldwide. Mythos Characters are surprising well-heeled travellers.

Historical Themes in the 1920s

- American Isolation
- Prohibition and moral temperance
- Rise of the Mob
- Boom Days of Pulp Magazines

Where do the Mythos fit?
The short, flippant answer is probably everywhere. Every realm in the Chronicles of Darkness has the potential for creatures from the Cthulhu Mythos to appear. That being said, I think some realms are more appropriate than others. For the most part, the Supernal may play host to entities that are Cthulhian Cosmic Horrors, but they don't interact with sleepers with any regularity. Part of the cosmic horror of the Mythos is that the horrors that protagonists encounter don't only exist, but they are a fundamental part of our world. That strongly suggests to me that while some Mythos monsters may originate from the Abyss, the vast majority of them originate from the Fallen World, that is our material realm, The Shadow, The Astral, or The Underworld.

(That said I often joke that Mastigos fight the Abyss by summoning Ringwraiths and the Hounds of Tindalos).

Since dreams and the Dreamlands are so important to many stories in the Mythos cannon, that means many creatures may have connections the Astral. Perhaps the Denizens of Leng are specialized Goetia that have found a way to walk out of dreams and into reality? And do they have some connection with Beasts? The Idigam are already fully loaded for cosmic horrors from the dawn of time, but there have been references to stranger spirits from beyond the Lunar perimeter reaching Earth too. What happens when a spirit of light lands in a pack's territory if it originated near Carcoasa? The Underworld bears mentioning too, since the Chthonians are about as alien as you can get and are capable of wrecking havoc even before they pass through an Aventian Gate.

Arcadia can't be overlooked either. I would be less willing to place Mythos characters there, although it can be done, as the Arkham Lost thread has shown us. That said, if stories can be told about it, you can find Changelings and the Wyrd in the mix. How exactly did the Hedge get changed by HPL and company?

And finally, there is the terrifying, horrifying possibility that the Mythos monsters don't need to come from beyond, and that they already exist in the Material realm. The God-Machine is Lovecraftian enough already, no changes needed. Mummy, on the other hand, exists almost wholly in the Material Realm and has dropped hints of both Narlythotep and the King in Yellow.

Fun times. Watch your Sanity.

Last edited by Second Chances; 08-23-2016, 04:25 PM.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

Tags: None

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08-23-2016, 04:43 PM #2

First things first: I wrote up modern Arkham as a Changeling 1e setting here and described Delta Green as a Hunter Compact here.

Second things second: Years ago, I was one of many people working on a



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fangame that eventually failed called Outsider: the Calling, which was focused on normal human beings unwillingly warped by the Mythos and trying to figure out where to go from there, which in practice looked like a rough middle ground between Changeling and Deviant with a Lovecraftian coat of paint. While the rules were incredibly shoddy and the project stalled pretty quickly, you may want to skim through it; a quick Google search should pull it up.

As for what already exists in the CofD that can be made Mythos-y (as opposed to pulling it in wholecloth to an admittedly crowded universe), you have quite a few options. Many of the heftier Mythos entities fit pretty well as Arcadian Keepers (imagine a musician like Eric Zahn dragged to the court of Azathoth to keep the blind idiot god asleep with unending music, or those called by dreams to serve Cthulhu who may eventually just wander into the surf im search of Rl'yeh) - and I think that's our easiest way in. There's a compelling argument to be made for Deep Ones and Mi-Go to be hobgoblins, I think, and that's to say nothing of how easily ghouls fit into Changeling as a race that wanders dreams with ease.

While Mummy is ripe for this (as you mention, the Herald of Forgotten Stars and Ochre-Masked King are Nyarlathotep and Hastur in all but name), I feel like the Judges, demons, and black huriyah are all too remote from reality for use in the average CofD game by default. I'm all for making them less so, but that would require some doing to explain how they get out of Duat/the orbit of their dead stars.

Mage is ripe with Lovecraftian potential, with the Temenos an easy analogue to the Dreamlands and the Abyss giving us gifts like sentient hostile alternate timelines. Some will argue that the Exarchs are Mythos critters, but I think they're too fundamentally tied into the humanist core of Awakening to fit that bill; the Great Old Ones don't care about oppressin mankind, they scarcely even notice it.

God-Machine Angels are always a fun option for this sort of thing, but I think the qashmallim are much more terrifying because of their inscrutability; Angels serve the God-Machine, but qashmallim just act in accordance with the invisible whims of whatever the Divine Fire is.

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08-23-2016, 04:56 PM #3

Huh, I didn't know you worked on Outsider. That cool!

I like the idea of Azathoth as one of the True Fae, but I do have other way of looking at him in CofD that I'm quite fond of. It ties nicely with using Qashmallim as Mythos entities. The Principle is nothing less than the guiding light of Azathoth. Why does it drive Prometheans to become human? None can say, for who can know the will of the Blind Idiot God. Yet is is both the Flux and the Elipis, the Promethean and the Pandoran. It's purpose is contradictory, and in all likelihood unintentional in the creation of new life.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | Patreon| He/His | Currently Writing: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast | Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist | Hunter | Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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08-23-2016, 05:00 PM #4

> *Originally posted by* ***Second Chances***
> *Huh, I didn't know you worked on Outsider. That cool!*
>
> *I like the idea of Azathoth as one of the True Fae, but I do have other way of looking at him in CofD that I'm quite fond of. It ties nicely with using Qashmallim as Mythos entities. The Principle is nothing less than the guiding light of Azathoth. Why does it drive Prometheans to become human? None can say, for who can know the will of the Blind Idiot God. Yet is is both the Flux and the Elipis, the Promethean and the Pandoran. It's purpose is contradictory, and in all likelihood unintentional in the creation of new life.*

Azathoth-as-Divine Fire is a brilliant idea I hadn't considered. All the Divine Fire seemingly wants is change, and what is change if not chaos by a kinder name? The dichotomy of Elpis and Flux is an artificial divide enforced by a pathetic human mind trying to assign binary morality to something completely random, as we can see with the utterly alien actions of Arch-Qashmal. At best, the creation of new souls by the Divine Fire is a random positive side effect of this process and at worst its a means of creating new souls to enslave or devour.

And of course, that's before we get into his title of "Nuclear Chaos" and what that means regarding the Zeky...

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08-23-2016, 05:09 PM #5

By the way, Second Chances, you really should check out Trail of Cthulhu if you haven't yet. While I mostly love it for the ruleset, many of the books and scenarios do very unique spins on some of the tired old Mythos critters.

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Haberdasher
Member

Join Date: Jun 2015
Posts: 818

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08-23-2016, 05:16 PM #6

What with the Dreamlands being an important part of the Mythos... would you discount the possibility that the Great Old Ones could be particularly ancient Nightmares? And that any physical appearance of them is actually a Beast going Incarnate?

Haberdasher's Requiem Conversions and Homebrew

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08-23-2016, 05:19 PM #7

> *Originally posted by* ***Haberdasher***
> *What with the Dreamlands being an important part of the Mythos... would you discount the possibility that the Great Old Ones could be particularly ancient Nightmares? And that any physical appearance of them is actually a Beast going Incarnate?*

I see that as similar to my description of the Exarchs above; Beasts are born from the incarnate fears of the human race while Lovecraft is all about the insignificance of mankind.

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LostLight
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 4531

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08-23-2016, 05:21 PM #8

Well, the Knights of St George and their Faceless Angels feels pretty Lovecraftian, and it won't be too hard to tie them to the Astral as a form of "dreamlands". The Chtonian from the Underworld as dead gods which were never born or dead races of the Old Ones before humanity also has a great potential. The Brineborn from WAtP and the Drowned from SotUK are both great options to explore, IMO, together with how Fate from Mummy works as "strange, cold stars from beyond earth". I'll be happy to contribute to the project, although my love for Lovecraft was pretty late to bloom (the first time I've heard about the Mythos was from the One Night at the Lonesome October, which is not that Lovecraftian, and I only understood things after reading Outsider: the Calling- but since discovering Eldritch Horror, I've pretty much fallen for the Mythos)

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"And all our knowledge is, Ourselves to know"- An Essay on Man

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08-23-2016, 05:22 PM #9

> *Originally posted by **atamajakki***
>
> *Azathoth-as-Divine Fire is a brilliant idea I hadn't considered. All the Divine Fire seemingly wants is change, and what is change if not chaos by a kinder name? The dichotomy of Elpis and Flux is an artificial divide enforced by a pathetic human mind trying to assign binary morality to something completely random, as we can see with the utterly alien actions of Arch-Qashmal. At best, the creation of new souls by the Divine Fire is a random positive side effect of this process and at worst its a means of creating new souls to enslave or devour.*
>
> *And of course, that's before we get into his title of "Nuclear Chaos" and what that means regarding the Zeky...*

I know, right? I had a minor freakout when I put two and two together on that one.

Your mention of dichotomy as being human constructs brings up a salient point about the Mythos though. They contradict each other all over the place, yet it still works. I see no reason why Azathoth-as-True Fae and Azathoth-as-Divine Fire can't coexist or even be the same being as Azathoth-as-Physical Star. These are things that are not meant to be know by human beings and they may very well be unknowable. Revel in the contradiction.

Ditto goes for R'lyeh. It is important to me at least that the city be an physical place that anyone can enter without crossing realms if you can find it when it rises. Nothing stops you from stepping into it via dreams (the Astral) or hearing the Call and becoming entrapped in Arcadia/R'lyeh by a Fae-That-Is-Not-A-Fae.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

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08-23-2016, 05:36 PM #10

> *Originally posted by **atamajakki***



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Posts: 11016

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> *And of course, that's before we get into his title of "Nuclear Chaos" and what that means regarding the Zeky...*

That refers to him being the center of things, the nucleus, not nuclear as in nuclear energy.

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Posts: 5487

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08-23-2016, 05:38 PM #11

> *Originally posted by* ***nofather***
>
> *That refers to him being the center of things, the nucleus, not nuclear as in nuclear energy.*

I'm aware of that, though later writers have ran with the atomic thing.

Remi. she/her. game designer.

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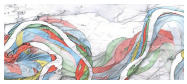
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08-23-2016, 05:50 PM #12

This has also highly influenced the way that I view Azathoth, even though it is definitely different from how HPL wrote him:



An Alien God — LessWrong
http://lesswrong.com/lw/kr/an_alien_god/

"A curious aspect of the theory of evolution," said Jacques Monod, "is that everybody thinks he understands it." …

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

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Member

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Posts: 4531

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08-23-2016, 06:11 PM #13

some more thoughts about Hunter-

while the core mood of Hunter is not very Lovecraftian (it is more in the lines of "I've just punched Cthulhu"), the material itself could be refulffed to fit the setting. The Lucifuge, for example, could be a hybrid lineage of humans who carry the blood of a pre-human races. My Mythos lore is not that deep, so I'm not sure what could replace God/the Saints for the MM. The Director Board from Cheiron Group are mysterious enough to be connected to the Mythos, and the same applies for the Cainte Heresy. The Knights of St George I've already mentioned, and the Faithful of Shulpae would also have a nice lovecraftian feeling.

That's what I have for the moment. Now- sleep :P

Check my STV content, Or My Homebrew

"And all our knowledge is, Ourselves to know"- An Essay on Man

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08-23-2016, 06:55 PM #14

Pangaeans fit the bill as it is. Considering what Harvest looks like it's easy to imagine Shub-Niggurath as Reproduction.

Last edited by nofather; 08-23-2016, 07:01 PM.

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08-23-2016, 07:33 PM #15

> *Originally posted by **LostLight***
> *some more thoughts about Hunter-*
>
> *while the core mood of Hunter is not very Lovecraftian (it is more in the*

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That's what I have for the moment. Now- sleep :P

I think the only one of those that is really a refluff would be MM. The others can be worked into the Mythos fairly naturally. The Lucifage may not like finding out that they aren't the bloodline of fire and brimstone demons, but what can you do. Although, I think it works perfectly fine to have one group of the Lucifage be demon-blooded and another group be Deep One Hybrids.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

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